

CECILE ROCA

New York, NY | 917-755-7583 | cecile@cecileroca.com | cecileroca.com | [linkedin.com/in/ceciler/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ceciler/)

Strategic, systems-first UX Architect and User Experience Designer with an MFA in Design & Technology, 7+ years of experience, and a unique foundation in law and business development. Following interactive environment design at Gallagher and Rockwell Group, specialized in high-velocity financial and corporate UX sprints at Synechron. Utilizing stakeholder workshops, mental modeling, and rapid wireframing, executes 4-to-6 week validation sprints that solve complex department bottlenecks and consolidate fragmented legacy ecosystems. A collaborative leader who co-creates rapid digital prototypes, guides UI designers to align execution with UX discoveries, and partners closely with developers and QA teams to ensure design fidelity, secure executive funding, and drive successful product launches.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **UX Design & Strategy:** Information Architecture, Interaction Design, Workshop Design & Executive Facilitation, Systems Thinking, Strategic Foresight, User Journey Mapping, Persona Development, Rapid Prototyping (Low/Mid-Fi), Inclusive Design.
- **Research & Synthesis:** Human-Centered Research, Usability Testing, Generative Research, Stakeholder Alignment, Data Synthesis, Decision Enablement.
- **Emerging Tech & Tools:** User-Centered LLM Applications, Generative AI (GenAI), Figma, Miro, Mural, Jira, Trello, Agile/Scrum Methodologies.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Synechron | Lead UX Designer | New York, NY | 2023 – 2025

- Defined the end-to-end UX research framework for advanced AI product ideation, establishing the foundational strategic vision for responsible, user-centered LLM applications within global financial institutions.
- Spearheaded the operational transformation and UX architecture to unify 16 legacy platforms into a single AI-powered portal, increasing workflow efficiency by 95% and reducing a 2-month process down to a 2-week digital experience.
- Secured executive approval and project funding for 3 high-priority GenAI initiatives by leading the co-creation of rapid digital and clickable prototypes, directly driving a 100% increase in consulting contract value.
- Led UX/UI design and cross-functional alignment for a 20+ member team to deliver a responsive website for a major insurance client, facilitating executive alignment workshops to define product vision and validate solutions.
- Collaborated directly with QA and engineering teams from concept through production, ensuring strict design fidelity, accessibility compliance, and a successful market launch.
- Partnered with executive stakeholders to map complex data collection flows and compliance requirements, ensuring user-centric design solutions met strict regulatory adherence standards.
- Championed the business value of human-centered design to C-suite clients, successfully securing long-term contract extensions for core client accounts.

Rockwell Group | UX Researcher & Content Strategist | New York, NY | 2018 – 2020

- Directed the end-to-end user experience and information design for a 34-screen immersive digital ecosystem, successfully managing 10 multimodal installations to streamline an intuitive, data-driven buyer journey.
- Conducted user testing and iterative prototyping to present to clients, successfully securing cross-functional alignment for foundational digital installations.
- Optimized the digital touchpoints and spatial UX design for the high-profile Hudson Yards sales center, directly ensuring the successful launch of the development's primary commercial engine.

Gallagher Design | UX Researcher | New York, NY | 2016 – 2018

- Led generative user research and UX production for interactive digital exhibits across corporate and museum clients, earning the 2019 Global Design Award and the Honor Award for Digital Experience Content.
- Managed the end-to-end design process to translate client visions into optimal user experiences using personas, user flows, and extensive iterative usability testing to guarantee successful product launches.

Parsons School of Design / UX Design Freelancer | New York, NY | 2016 – 2022

- **Guest Lecturer (Parsons):** Developed and delivered engaging Design and Coding lectures to undergraduate students, mentoring future designers on user interface principles and front-end execution.
- **UX Consultant (University of Michigan):** Engineered the user-centered design, strategic planning, and execution of a multimodal research survey system, successfully collecting and synthesizing data from over 1,000 active users.
- **Lead UX/UI Designer (Public Sector Campaign):** Owned the end-to-end digital strategy and product launch for a Minnesota Representative's campaign website, optimizing user flows, design, and digital experience that contributed to a successful election.

AWARDS

- **Gold Star Award (Two-Time Recipient) | Synechron** (Recognized for outstanding UX design work and executive client collaboration)
- **Global Design Award & Honor Award for Digital Experience Content | SEG D** (For The Mississippi Arts & Entertainment Experience Center)
- **Dean's Scholarship | Parsons School of Design** (2020 – 2022)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Fine Arts (MFA) in Design & Technology** – Parsons School of Design, The New School (2020 - 2022)
- **User Experience Design Bootcamp (Certification) | General Assembly** (2015)
- **Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Liberal Arts** – Eugene Lang College, The New School
- **Ecuadorian Law Degree coursework completed** – Universidad Internacional del Ecuador